

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN DANCE

MODULE - 3

FOLK DANCE FORMS

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

INDIAN CLASSICAL DANCE FORMS

7

KATHAK



It was also influenced by Persian costumes and styles of dancing.

- 1 Tracing its origins from the Ras Leela of Brajbhoomi, Kathak is the traditional dance form of Uttar Pradesh.
- 2 Kathak derived its name from the 'Kathaka' or the story-teller who recites verses from the epics, with gestures and music.
- 3 During the Mughal era, the dance form degenerated into lascivious style and branched off into court dance.
- 5 The classical style of Kathak was revived by Lady Leela Sokhey in the twentieth century.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

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KATHAK

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAK DANCE



Leila Sokhey known as Madame Menaka was a key figure in transforming Kathak into a respectable dance form.

1

An important feature of Kathak is the development of different gharanas as it is based on Hindustani style of music:

- ❖ **Lucknow** : Reached its peak under the reign of Nawab Wajid Ali Khan. It puts more importance on expression and grace.
- ❖ **Jaipur** : Initiated by Bhanuji, it emphasised fluency, speed and long rhythmic patterns.
- ❖ **Raigarh** : It developed under the patronage of Raja Chakradhar Singh. It is unique in its emphasis on percussion music.
- ❖ **Banaras** : It developed under Janakiprasad.

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KATHAK

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAK DANCE

2 The elements of Kathak recital are:

- ❖ **Ananda** or the introductory item through which the dancer enters the stage.
- ❖ **Thaat** comprising soft and varied movements.
- ❖ **Todas** and **Tukdas** are small pieces of fast rhythm.
- ❖ **Jugalbandi** is the main attraction of Kathak recital which shows a competitive play between the dancer and the tabla player.
- ❖ **Padhant** is a special feature in which the dancer recites complicated bols and demonstrate them.
- ❖ **Tarana** is similar to **thillana**, which comprises of pure rhythmic movements before the end.
- ❖ **Kramalaya** is the concluding piece comprising of intricate and fast footwork.
- ❖ **Gat bhaav** is dance without music or chanting. This is used to outline different mythological episodes.

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KATHAK

SOME FEATURES OF KATHAK DANCE



Birju Maharaj

3 Kathak dance form is characterised by the use of intricate footworks and pirouettes.

4 Kathak is generally accompanied with dhrupad music.

FAMOUS PROPONENTS

Birju Maharaj, Lacchu Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Damayanti Joshi etc.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

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SATTRIYA



- 1 Sattriya dance form was introduced by the Vaishnava saint Shankaradeva in the 15th century A.D.
- 2 The art form derives its name from the Vaishnava monasteries known as Sattras, where it was primarily practised.

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SATTRIYA

SOME FEATURES OF SATTRIYA DANCE



Vaishnav monks put on their costumes for a village performance on the Majuli island of Assam

- 1 The dance form was an amalgamation of various dance forms prevalent in Assam, **mainly Ojapali and Devdasi**.
- 2 The focus of the Sattriya recitals is the devotional aspect of dance and to narrates mythological stories of Vishnu.
- 3 The dance is generally performed in group by **male monks known as Bhokots** as part of their daily rituals.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

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SATTRIYA

SOME FEATURES OF SATTRIYA DANCE



- 4 Khol and flute form the major accompanying instruments of this dance form. The songs are composition of Shankaradeva known as Borgeets.
- 5 There is great emphasis on rhythmic syllables and dance postures along with footwork. It combine both Lasya and Tandava elements.
- 6 The Sattriya dance tradition has strictly laid down rules in respect of hand gestures and footwork.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

- 1 The multitude of folklore, legends and myth prevalent in various parts of India, combined with local song and dance traditions, results in a rich mix of composite art.



- 2 The folk dance forms are generally spontaneous, crude and performed by the masses.
- 3 This simplicity gives the art form an inherent beauty.
- 4 However, these art forms have remained confined to a certain sect of people or at a particular locality, to whom the knowledge has been passed down the ages.

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1

CHHAU



Credits: UNESCO

1

The word Chhau originates from 'Chhaya' meaning shadow.

2

It is a form of mask dance that uses vigorous martial movements to narrate mythological stories.

3

Some narrations also use natural themes such as Sarpa nritya (serpent dance) or Mayur Nritya (peacock dance).

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



4

There are three main styles of Chhau dance – Saraikella Chhau in Jharkhand, Mayurbhanj Chhau in Odisha and Purulia Chhau in West Bengal.

5

Of these, Mayurbhanj Chhau artists don't wear masks.

6

In 2011, UNESCO inscribed Chhau in the Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.



UTTAR PRADESH

BIHAR



PURULIA

JHARKHAND

SERAIKELLA

WEST
BENGAL

MADHYA



CHHATTISGARH

ODISHA

MAYURBHANJ

MAHARASHTRA

TELANGANA

ASH



INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



CHHAU Mask of West Bengal

The art of making masks in Chhau dance form

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



It leans heavily upon the martial arts tradition

7

This is a tribal martial arts dance popular in West Bengal, Jharkhand and Orissa.

8

It is mainly performed during regional festivals, especially the spring festival of Chaitra Parva, which is a thirteen-days long event.

9

Chhau dance is a tradition from eastern India that enacts episodes from epics including the Mahabharata and Ramayana, local folklore and abstract themes.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



- 10 Its origin is traceable to indigenous forms of dance and martial practices.
- 11 Its vocabulary of movement includes mock combat techniques, stylized gaits of birds and animals and movements modelled on the chores of village housewives.
- 12 Chhau is taught to male dancers from families of traditional artists or from local communities.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



13 The dance is performed at night in an open space to traditional and folk melodies, played on the reed pipes "mohuri" and "shehnai."

14 The reverberating drumbeats of a variety of drums dominate the accompanying music ensemble.

15 Chhau is an integral part of the culture of these communities.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

1

CHHAU



It puts a heavy toll on the performing artists as the art cannot be a profitable income-fetching activity

16 It binds together people from different social strata and ethnic background with diverse social practices, beliefs, professions and languages.

17 However, increasing industrialization, economic pressures and new media are leading to a decrease in collective participation with communities becoming disconnected from their roots.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

2 KALBELIA

- 1 It is a sensuous folk dance performed by the women of the Kalbelia community of Rajasthan.



Credits: UNESCO

- 2 Once professional snake handlers, Kalbelia today evoke their former occupation in music and dance that is evolving in new and creative ways.
- 3 Today, women in flowing black skirts dance and swirl, replicating the movements of a serpent,
- 4 Men accompany them on the "khanjari" percussion instrument and the "poongi," a woodwind instrument traditionally played to capture snakes.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

2 KALBELIA

- 5 The songs also demonstrate the poetic acumen of the Kalbelia, who are reputed to compose lyrics spontaneously and improvise songs during performances.



- 6 Transmitted from generation to generation, the songs and dances form part of an oral tradition for which no texts or training manuals exist.
- 7 Song and dance are a matter of pride for the Kalbelia community, and a marker of their identity at a time when their traditional travelling lifestyle and role in rural society are diminishing.
- 8 The UNESCO has inscribed Kalbelia folk songs and dances in the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2011.

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3

GARBA



1 Garba is a popular folk dance of Gujarat, held at the time of Navaratri.

2 Garba actually refers to “Garba deep” – an earthen pot with holes, in which a lamp is lit and women dance around it in circular movements with rhythmic clapping.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

3

GARBA



3

This is performed in honour of Goddess Amba.

4

This **fertility dance** begins by placing perforated earthen pots with oil lamps inside to the pots symbolizing the embryonic life.

5

Each pot is then balanced on every dancer's head as she and the others move around in circles, **snapping their fingers and clapping their hands** to produce a fast beat.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

3

GARBA



6

At times even men dance the Garba, while singing and clapping like the womenfolk and this form of dance is known as Garbi.

7

Traditionally the Garba is danced only at night.

8

In an evolved version, the dance can be performed by its own sake and at any time.

9

It is thus especially performed on occasions of weddings, festivals, engagements and other moments of happiness.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

4 DANDIYA RAAS

- 1 It is an energetic , lively dance form in which polished sticks or dandiyaas are used which represents a mock fight between Durga and Mahishasura.



- 2 The major difference between the Garba and Dandiya dance performances is that Garba is performed before “Aarti” (worshipping ritual) as devotional performances in the honor of the Goddess, while Dandiya is performed after it, as a part of merriment.
- 3 Also known as “Stick Dance” (where the stick refers to the sword of Durga) as performers use a pair of colorfully decorated sticks, the circular movements of Dandiya Raas are slightly more complex than that of Garba.

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4 DANDIYA RAAS

4 One of the circles revolves clockwise, while the other revolves anti clockwise.

5 The dance is very energetic and fast paced activity, which leaves no scope for lethargy.



6 The dancers are accompanied by an instrument player with a drum. The person stands in the Centre of the two circles and leads the dancers with his beats.

7 The site of hundreds of people swaying on the beats of folk music is awe-inspiring.

8 The sticks or the Dandiya, when struck together in a rhythm, produce foot tapping musical waves.

9 The best Raas dancers of the region are the Kathiawari Ras dancers from Saurashtra.

INDIAN DANCE FORMS

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5

DADRA

- It is the semi-classical form of dance popular in Uttar Pradesh, accompanied by the music of the same style.
- It was extremely popular among the courtesans of the Lucknow region.

6

TARANGAMEL

- It is the folk dance of Goa that celebrates the youthfulness of the region.
- It is performed during Dussehra and Holi.
- The use of rainbow-like costumes with multi coloured flags and streamers make it a visual spectacle.

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GHOOMAR



- 1 It is a traditional folk dance performed by the **women** of the **Bhil** tribe in **Rajasthan**.
- 2 It is characterized by the pirouetting movements of the women, which brings into prominence the multi-coloured vibrancies of the flowing Ghaghra.

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8 BHANGRA/GIDDHA



- 1 Bhangra is the highly energetic folk dance of Punjab.
- 2 Accompanied with infectious and catchy drum beats, it is a popular form of celebration during festivities.
- 3 Giddha is the female counterpart of the male Bhangra.

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9

BRAJ RASLILA



1

Braj Raslila is a popular folk dance of the region of Uttar Pradesh, revolving around the adolescent love stories of Radha and Krishna.

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